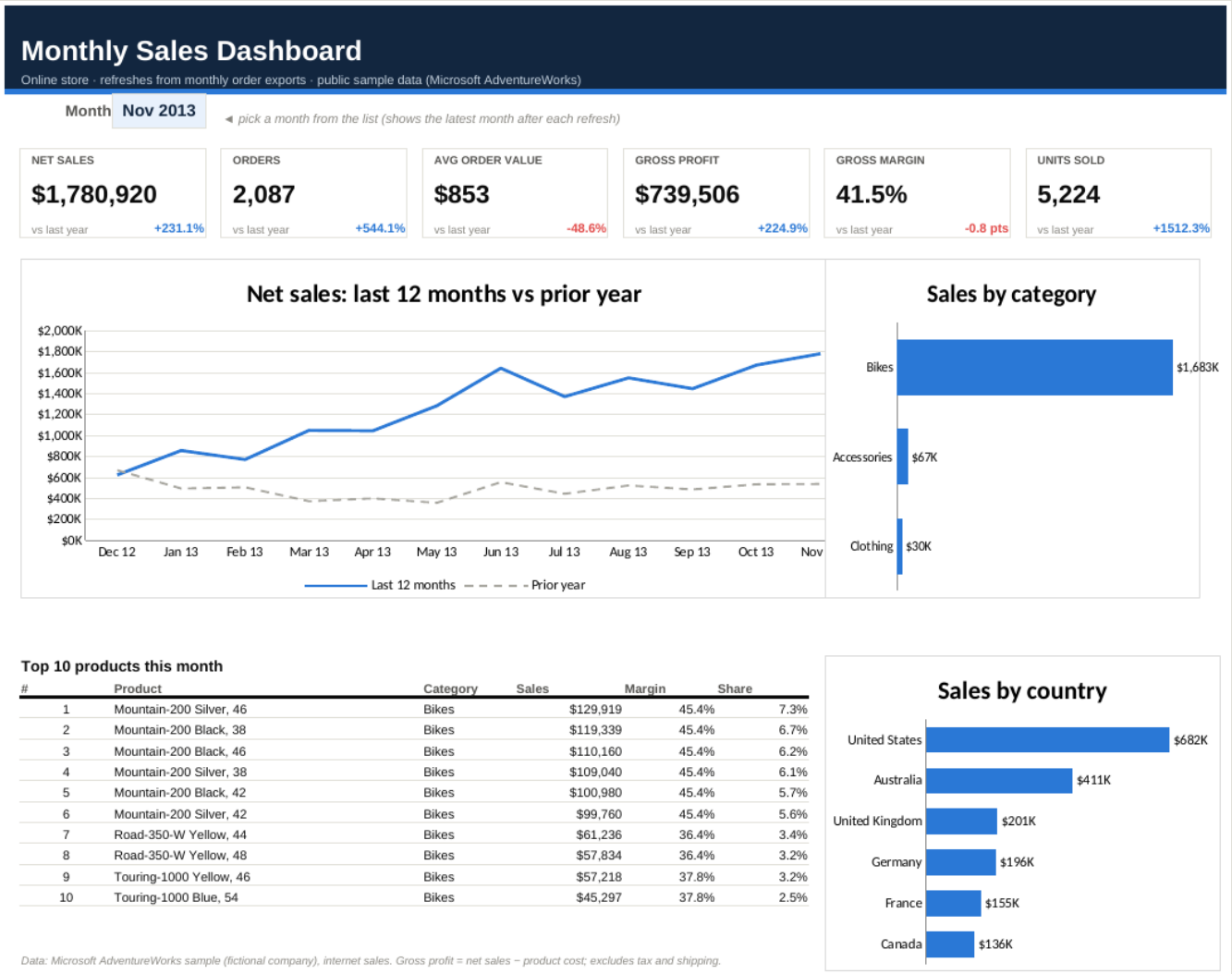
EXCEL · POWER QUERY · USER GUIDE

How to refresh your sales dashboard

Three steps, about one minute, every month. No formulas to edit, no copy and paste.

Every month

1. **Export last month's orders** from your store (Shopify, WooCommerce, POS) as CSV, and save the file in the `exports` folder. Keep the name pattern `orders_export_YYYY-MM.csv`.
2. **Open the dashboard** and click **Data → Refresh All**. Wait a few seconds while the status bar shows the query running.
3. **Read the Dashboard sheet.** The **Month** box jumps to the newest month automatically. To look at another month, pick it from the box's list.



What you see

Section	What it tells you
Six KPI tiles	Net sales, orders, average order value, gross profit, gross margin and units for the selected month, each compared with the same month last year (blue = up, red = down).
Last 12 months vs prior year	Whether growth is steady or a one-month spike.
Sales by category and country	Where this month's sales came from.
Top 10 products	Best sellers with their margin and share of the month, so you see if growth comes from profitable products.

What the refresh does for you

The query `SalesExports` reads every file in the folder, removes blank rows and lines exported twice, trims extra spaces in product names, fixes category capitalization, and adds the month and the cost of each line. The same rules run every month, so the numbers are comparable.

> **Good to know**
> • Don't type in the **Data** sheet: it is replaced on every refresh.
> • A new product appears in the totals immediately. To show it in the Top 10, add its name and category at the bottom of the product list on the **Calc** sheet.
> • Orders are counted once each (line item 1 of every order). Gross profit is net sales minus product cost; tax and shipping are excluded.
> • If you move the dashboard to another computer, update the folder path once: Data → Queries & Connections → right-click **SalesExports** → Edit → Advanced Editor → first line.

Example shown with public sample data (Microsoft AdventureWorks, a fictional company).